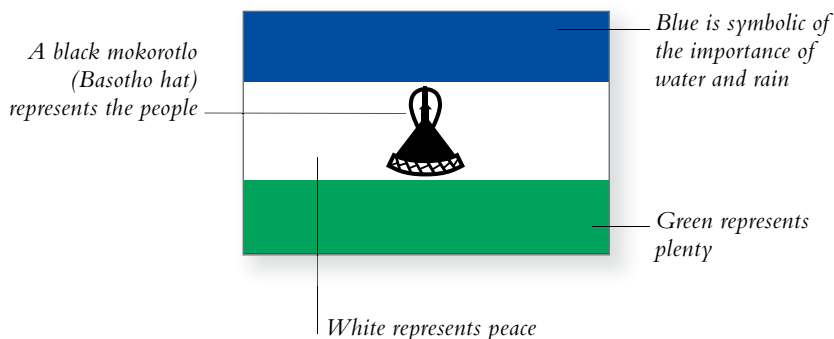


Lesotho

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** October 4, 2006 **Usage:** National and Civil



Africa



Lesotho was formerly known as British Basutoland but is now known by its Sesotho name. It became independent in 1966.

The national flag was changed to commemorate the fortieth anniversary of independence. The change from a shield to a black mokorotlo, a Basotho hat, reflects a peaceful future for the country.

ROYAL ARMS OF LESOTHO

On the national flag only the outline of the shield is shown, with its tufted spine, and two weapons, but on the

Royal Standard the whole arms appear in color.

The shield, of African design, contains a crocodile, which is a symbol of King Moshoeshoe I, who founded the state in 1824. It stands on a representation of Mount Thaba Bosiu, the Mountain of Night, and is supported by two Basuto ponies. Behind the shield is a spear and a knobkerrie, a local club.

ARMS OF LESOTHO

Two Basuto ponies support the shield

